

CRY

1. Passage anchor

> “I noticed a little girl ****crying**** outside a souvenir shop.”

Passage meaning

****cry**** = produce tears because of sadness, pain, fear, distress, etc.

****哭 ; 流淚****

Here, the little girl is upset and is visibly crying.

Practice

1. The child began to ****cry**** when she could not find her mother.

那個孩子找不到媽媽時開始****哭****。

2. He tried not to ****cry****, but tears filled his eyes.

他努力忍住不****哭****，但眼裡充滿了淚水。

Core meanings of CRY

2. cry — shed tears

As a verb:

= produce tears because of emotion, pain, fear, distress, happiness, etc.

****哭 ; 流淚****

Examples

1. She ****cried**** after hearing the news.

她聽到消息後****哭了****。

2. The baby started ****crying****.

嬰兒開始****哭鬧****。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. cry — tears / period of crying

As a noun:

= act or period of crying

****哭泣；一場哭****

Examples

1. Sometimes you just need a good ****cry****.
有時候你就是需要****好好哭一場****。
2. She had a long ****cry**** and felt better afterwards.
她****大哭了一場****，之後感覺好多了。

Cry because of different emotions

4. cry with sadness / pain

= shed tears because of sadness or physical pain

****因悲傷 / 疼痛而哭****

Examples

1. He ****cried with pain**** after hurting his leg.
他腿受傷後因疼痛而****哭了****。
2. She ****cried with sadness**** when they said goodbye.
道別時，她因悲傷而****落淚****。

5. cry with happiness / joy

= shed tears because of strong positive emotion

****喜極而泣；因開心而流淚****

Examples

1. She ****cried with joy**** when she saw her family.
她看到家人時****喜極而泣****。
2. He was so relieved that he almost ****cried****.
他如釋重負，幾乎****感動得流淚****。

The verb does not itself tell you whether the emotion is positive or negative.

6. cry with laughter

= laugh so strongly that tears come from the eyes

****笑到流淚****

Examples

1. The story made us ****cry with laughter****.

那個故事令我們****笑到流淚****。

2. I was ****crying with laughter**** by the end.

到最後我已經****笑出眼淚****了。

Loud call / shout

7. cry — shout or call loudly

Literary/formal compared with everyday ****shout****:

= say or call something loudly, often because of fear, excitement, pain, or urgency

****喊叫；大聲呼喊****

Examples

1. "Stop!" she ****cried****.

「停下！」她****大喊道****。

2. He ****cried for help****.

他****大聲呼救****。

Distinct from shedding tears.

8. cry — a loud shout or call

As a noun:

= loud vocal sound made by a person

****喊聲；叫聲****

Examples

1. We heard a ****cry**** from the next room.
我們聽到隔壁房間傳來一聲****叫喊****。
2. A sudden ****cry of pain**** came from the crowd.
人群中突然傳來一聲****痛苦的叫喊****。

Sounds made by animals / birds

9. cry — characteristic animal or bird sound

= call or sound made by an animal or bird

****鳴叫聲；叫聲****

Examples

1. We heard the ****cry of a seagull****.
我們聽到海鷗的****鳴叫聲****。
2. The strange ****cry**** of the animal echoed through the forest.
那動物奇怪的****叫聲****在森林中迴盪。

This is usually a noun sense.

Appeal / request for help

10. cry for help — literal

= shout because assistance is urgently needed

****呼救；大聲求救****

Examples

1. Someone heard her ****cry for help****.
有人聽到了她的****呼救聲****。
2. His ****cries for help**** attracted attention.
他的****呼救聲****引起了別人的注意。

11. cry for help — figurative

= action or behavior showing that someone desperately needs support

****求助訊號；求救表現****

Examples

1. His behavior may have been a ****cry for help****.
他的行為可能是一種****求助訊號****。
2. The message sounded like a ****cry for help****.
那段訊息聽起來像是在****向人求助****。

Important figurative extension.

Protest / demand / public call

12. cry — public demand or appeal

= loud or strongly expressed demand for something

****呼聲；要求****

Examples

1. There were growing ****cries for reform****.
要求改革的****呼聲****越來越高。
2. The incident led to renewed ****cries for change****.
事件再次引發要求改變的****呼聲****。

13. rallying cry

= phrase, idea, or demand used to unite and motivate a group

****號召口號；鼓舞人心的訴求****

Examples

1. The phrase became a ****rallying cry**** for the movement.
這句話成了該運動的****號召口號****。
2. Equality became their ****rallying cry****.
平等成了他們共同的****號召訴求****。

14. battle cry / war cry

= shout or slogan used to encourage people in battle or struggle

****戰吼；戰鬥口號****

Examples

1. The soldiers shouted their ****battle cry****.
士兵高喊****戰吼****。
2. The slogan became a political ****battle cry****.
那句口號成了一個強烈的****鬥爭口號****。

Cry out

15. cry out

= suddenly shout, often because of pain, fear, surprise, or strong emotion

****大叫；喊出聲****

Examples

1. She ****cried out**** in pain.
她痛得****叫出聲來****。
2. He ****cried out**** when he saw the accident.
他看到事故時****驚叫了一聲****。

High-value phrasal verb.

16. cry out for something

= obviously and urgently need something

****迫切需要；亟需****

Examples

1. The old building ****cries out for renovation****.
那棟舊建築****亟需翻新****。

2. The situation ****cries out for action****.

這個情況****迫切需要採取行動****。

This is fully figurative.

Cry one's eyes out

17. cry one's eyes out

= cry very hard for a long time

****哭得很厲害；哭得死去活來****

Examples

1. She ****cried her eyes out**** after the breakup.

分手後她****大哭了一場****。

2. The child was ****crying his eyes out****.

那個孩子****哭得非常厲害****。

Cry oneself to sleep

18. cry oneself to sleep

= keep crying until one eventually falls asleep

****哭著哭著睡著；哭到睡著****

Examples

1. She ****cried herself to sleep****.

她****哭到睡著了****。

2. The child finally ****cried himself to sleep****.

那個孩子最後****哭著睡著了****。

Cry on someone's shoulder

19. cry on someone's shoulder

= seek emotional comfort from someone by talking about one's problems

****向某人傾訴；尋求安慰****

Examples

1. You can always ****cry on my shoulder****.

你隨時都可以****向我傾訴****。

2. She needed someone to ****cry on their shoulder****.

她需要有人讓她****傾訴、尋求安慰****。

Often figurative; literal crying is not necessary.

No use crying over spilled milk

20. cry over spilled milk

= be upset about something that has already happened and cannot be changed

****為無法挽回的事懊悔；覆水難收，不必再後悔****

Usually:

> There's no use crying over spilled milk.

Examples

1. There is no point ****crying over spilled milk****.

對已無法挽回的事再****懊悔也沒有用****。

2. We made a mistake, but there's no use ****crying over spilled milk****.

我們犯了錯，但事情已發生，再****後悔也無補於事****。

BrE spelling commonly: ****spilt milk****.

Cry wolf

21. cry wolf

= repeatedly give a false warning so that people stop believing you when danger is real

****謊報危險；屢次發假警報而失去信用****

Examples

1. If you keep ****crying wolf****, nobody will believe you.
如果你一直****謊報危險****，就沒有人會再相信你。

2. Officials were accused of ****crying wolf****.
官員被指責****屢次發出誇大的假警報****。

Very high-value idiom.

Cry foul

22. cry foul

= protest that something is unfair, dishonest, or against the rules
****抗議不公平；指控違規 / 不公****

Examples

1. Competitors ****cried foul**** over the decision.
競爭者對這項決定****抗議不公****。

2. Fans ****cried foul**** after the rule change.
規則改變後，球迷紛紛****表示不滿並指控不公****。

A far cry from

23. a far cry from

= very different from something else
****與.....大不相同；相差甚遠****

Examples

1. His new life is ****a far cry from**** his school days.
他現在的生活與學生時代****大不相同****。

2. The final product was ****a far cry from**** what we expected.
最終產品與我們預期的****相差甚遠****。

Very common and semantically far removed from literal crying.

For crying out loud

24. for crying out loud

Informal:

= expression of annoyance, surprise, or impatience

拜託！；真是的！

Examples

1. **For crying out loud**, be careful!

**拜託！小心一點！

2. Oh, **for crying out loud**!

唉，**真是的！**

The phrase does not literally refer to crying.

Related forms

25. crying — noun/gerund

= act of shedding tears

哭泣

Examples

1. I could hear **crying** in the next room.

我聽到隔壁房間有人**哭泣**。

2. The baby's **crying** woke everyone up.

嬰兒的**哭聲**把所有人吵醒了。

26. crying — adjective in fixed expressions

In a few established expressions, **crying** means extremely obvious or serious.

crying shame

= something very unfortunate or regrettable

****非常可惜的事；令人遺憾的事****

1. It's a ****crying shame**** that the building was demolished.
那棟建築被拆掉實在****太可惜了****。

This usage is idiomatic and should not be generalized freely.

CRIER

27. town crier

= traditional official who publicly announces news in a loud voice

****城鎮傳令員；街頭公告員****

Examples

1. The ****town crier**** announced the festival.
****城鎮傳令員****宣布節慶消息。
2. A costumed ****town crier**** opened the ceremony.
一名穿傳統服裝的****傳令員****為典禮揭幕。

****Crier**** by itself is uncommon today, but ****town crier**** remains established.

CRYBABY

28. crybaby

Informal, often insulting:

= person, especially a child, who cries or complains very easily

****愛哭鬼；動不動就哭 / 抱怨的人****

Examples

1. Don't call the child a ****crybaby****.
不要叫那個孩子****愛哭鬼****。
2. He was teased for being a ****crybaby****.
他因為被說是****愛哭鬼****而遭取笑。

Register-sensitive.

High-value contrasts

29. cry vs weep

****cry****

= ordinary everyday word for shedding tears

****哭；流淚****

****weep****

= more literary/formal, often suggesting sustained or emotional crying

****哭泣；落淚****

Compare:

> The child cried.

> 孩子哭了。

> She wept quietly.

> 她靜靜地落淚。

30. cry vs sob

****cry****

= general word for shedding tears

****sob****

= cry while breathing in short, broken, gasping breaths

****啜泣；抽泣****

Compare:

> She was crying.

> 她在哭。

> She was sobbing uncontrollably.

> 她不停地抽泣。

31. cry vs shout

****cry****

= can mean call out loudly, often with strong emotion; somewhat literary in this sense

****shout****

= general everyday word for speaking very loudly

****喊 ; 大叫****

Compare:

> "Help!" she cried.

> 「救命！」她大喊。

> He shouted across the room.

> 他隔著房間大聲喊。

32. cry vs scream

****scream****

= extremely loud, high-pitched cry caused by fear, pain, excitement, etc.

****尖叫****

****cry****

= much broader; may mean tears or simply a loud call.

33. cry vs tears

****cry****

= action/process

****哭****

****tear****

= drop of liquid from the eye

****眼淚****

Compare:

> She cried.

> 她哭了。

> A tear rolled down her cheek.

> 一滴眼淚滑過她的臉頰。

Meaning map

The central human idea of **cry** has two major branches:

A. Emotional tears

cry because you are upset

→ **哭；流淚**

This is the passage sense.

From this come:

> have a good cry

> → **好好哭一場**

> cry one's eyes out

> → **大哭**

> cry oneself to sleep

> → **哭到睡著**

B. Loud vocal sound

cry out

→ **大叫**

From this develop:

> cry for help

> → **呼救**

> cry of pain

> → **痛苦的叫聲**

> animal cry

> → **動物鳴叫聲**

And the idea of a loud public call develops into:

> cries for reform

> → **要求改革的呼聲**

> rallying cry
> → **號召口號**

Several idioms have moved even further:

> cry wolf
> → **發假警報**

> cry foul
> → **抗議不公**

> a far cry from
> → **與.....相差甚遠**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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cry — shed tears	因悲傷、疼痛、恐懼、感動等而哭 / 流淚
a cry — period of crying	一次 / 一陣哭泣；哭一場
cry with sadness/pain	因悲傷或疼痛而哭
cry with joy	因非常開心或感動而流淚；喜極而泣
cry with laughter	笑得太厲害而流眼淚
cry — shout/call	帶強烈情緒地大聲喊叫 / 呼喊
a cry — shout	人發出的喊聲 / 叫聲
cry — animal sound	動物或鳥類的鳴叫聲
cry for help — literal	因需要緊急援助而大聲呼救
cry for help — figurative	顯示某人迫切需要支援的求助訊號
cries for something	公開而強烈要求某事的呼聲
rallying cry	用來團結、鼓舞一群人的號召口號 / 共同訴求
battle cry / war cry	戰鬥時的戰吼；鼓舞鬥志的口號
cry out	因疼痛、恐懼、驚訝等突然大叫
cry out for something	明顯而迫切地需要某事
cry one's eyes out	非常傷心地大哭很久
cry oneself to sleep	一直哭到睡著
cry on someone's shoulder	向某人傾訴煩惱並尋求安慰
cry over spilled/spilt milk	為已發生且無法改變的事懊悔
cry wolf	多次虛報危險，以致真正有事時無人相信
cry foul	抗議某件事不公平、違規或不誠實
a far cry from	與另一事物非常不同；相差甚遠
for crying out loud	非正式：表示不耐煩 / 惱怒的「拜託、真是的」
crying — noun	哭泣這一行為；哭聲
crying shame	非常令人惋惜 / 遺憾的事情

town crier	傳統上在公共場所大聲宣讀公告的傳令員	
crybaby	非正式貶義：很容易哭或抱怨的人；愛哭鬼	

Passage recap

> “I noticed a little girl **crying** outside a souvenir shop.”

Here:

cry = **to produce tears because one is upset, frightened, hurt, etc.**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **哭**
* **哭泣**
* **流淚**

Natural contextual translation:

我注意到紀念品店外有個小女孩在哭。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

cry
= **to shed tears because of strong emotion, pain, fear, or distress**

哭；流淚

The major learner distinction is that **cry** does not always involve tears:

> **The girl was crying.**

> → 女孩在**哭泣**

but:

> **“Help!” he cried.**

> → 他**大聲喊道**：「救命！」

and:

> **a cry for reform**

> → 要求改革的**呼聲**

There are also several highly lexicalized expressions:

> ****cry wolf****

> → ****虛報危險****

> ****cry foul****

> → ****抗議不公****

> ****a far cry from****

> → ****與.....相差甚遠****

So the passage uses the straightforward ****tear-producing emotional**** sense, while the wider family develops from both ****weeping**** and ****loud vocal calling****.